UNIT 41.3 · LEVEL C1

Participle clauses – absolute constructions

50 questions · 6 parts

Date: _____ Score: _____ / 50

When you finish, check the Answer Key at the end of this unit.

Part A · Multiple Choice (questions 1–10)

Circle the letter of the correct answer.

1 _____ nice, we decided to go to the beach.

a) Being the weather **b)** The weather been
c) The weather being **d)** Weather is

2 The work _____, she went home.

a) finished **b)** finish **c)** finishing **d)** to finish

3 The sun _____ set, we returned to the hotel.

a) has **b)** had **c)** having been **d)** having

4 He sat in the chair, his eyes _____.

a) closing **b)** closed **c)** close **d)** to close

5 _____ the meeting cancelled, we had a free afternoon.

a) Of **b)** With **c)** By **d)** At

6 Which sentence contains an absolute construction?

a) Walking home, I met Tom.
b) I met Tom walking home.
c) Having stopped, I went out.
d) The rain having stopped, we went out.

7 _____ considered, it was a good result.

a) All things **b)** All thing **c)** Everything **d)** Things all

8 Dinner _____, the guests moved to the lounge.

a) was over **b)** over being **c)** being over **d)** is over

9 She walked in, her hair _____ from the rain.

a) soaking **b)** soak **c)** to soak **d)** soaked

10 Her mother _____ ill, she stayed home to help.

a) being **b)** been **c)** is **d)** to be

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Part B · Fill in the Gaps (questions 11–20)

Write the missing word in each blank.

11 The weather _____ nice, we went for a walk.

12 The work _____, she went home.

13 The sun having _____, we turned back.

14 He stood there, his arms _____.

15 _____ things considered, it went well.

16 The children _____ asleep, we watched a film.

17 Her homework _____, she went out to play.

18 With the door _____, we could hear everything.

19 The guests _____ left, we cleaned the house.

20 The train being _____, we took a taxi.

Part C · Unscramble the Words (questions 21–28)

Put the words in the correct order to make a sentence. Write it on the line. Remember the capital letter and the full stop.

21 **the / weather / being / nice / we / went / out**

_____

22 **the / work / finished / she / went / home**

_____

23 **the / sun / having / set / we / returned**

_____

24 **he / sat / there / his / eyes / closed**

_____

25 **all / things / considered / it / went / well**

_____

26 **her / mother / being / ill / she / stayed / home**

_____

27 **with / the / door / open / we / heard / everything**

_____

28 **the / guests / having / left / we / cleaned / up**

_____

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Part D · Choose and Complete (questions 29–35)

Choose the correct option and write it in the blank.

29 *Choose the participle phrase.*
_____ nice, we went to the beach.
Options: **The weather being** / **Being the weather** / **Weather been**

30 *Choose the subject.*
_____ finished, she went home.
Options: **The work** / **Working** / **To work**

31 *Choose the auxiliary.*
The sun _____ set, we returned.
Options: **has** / **having** / **had**

32 *Choose the participle.*
He sat there, his eyes _____ tightly.
Options: **closed** / **closing** / **close**

33 *Choose the word.*
_____ things considered, it went well.
Options: **All** / **Every** / **Any**

34 *Choose the participle.*
Her mother _____ ill, she stayed home.
Options: **being** / **been** / **is**

35 *Choose the auxiliary.*
The guests _____ left, we cleaned up.
Options: **has** / **having** / **had**

Part E · Matching (questions 36–40)

Match the items. Write the correct letter next to each number.

36 Match each absolute clause to its meaning.

1. The weather being nice, _____
2. The work finished, _____
3. Her mother being ill, _____
4. All things considered, _____

A. After the work was finished,
B. Taking everything into account,
C. Because the weather was nice,
D. Since her mother was ill,

37 Match each beginning to its ending.

1. The sun having set, _____
2. Dinner over, _____
3. The exams finished, _____
4. With the door open, _____

A. we heard everything.
B. we went back.
C. they moved to the lounge.
D. the students celebrated.

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38 Match each example to its type.

1. The rain having stopped _____
2. The work finished _____
3. The weather being nice _____
4. With the lights off _____

A. with + noun + adjective
B. present participle
C. past participle
D. perfect participle

39 Match each full clause to its absolute form.

1. As the train was late, _____
2. When the work had been done, _____
3. After the sun had set, _____
4. Since the shop was closed, _____

A. The work done,
B. The sun having set,
C. The shop being closed,
D. The train being late,

40 Match each feature to its description.

1. Own subject _____
2. Formal style _____
3. Meaning _____
4. Fixed phrase _____

A. Gives reason, time or condition
B. Appears before the participle
C. All things considered
D. Common in writing and speeches

Part F · Find the Error (questions 41–50)

Each sentence has one mistake. Underline it and write the correct word.

41 The weather been nice, we went out. Correct word: _____

42 The work finish, she went home. Correct word: _____

43 The sun have set, we returned. Correct word: _____

44 He stood there, his arms fold. Correct word: _____

45 All thing considered, it was fine. Correct word: _____

46 The meeting cancelling, we left early. Correct word: _____

47 Her mother being ill, so she stayed home.
Correct word: _____

48 The rain having stop, we went out. Correct word: _____

49 With the lights turning off, the room was dark.
Correct word: _____

50 The exam been over, the students celebrated.
Correct word: _____

A	B	C	D	E	F	Total
____ / 10	____ / 10	____ / 8	____ / 7	____ / 5	____ / 10	____ **/ 50**

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Answer Key

Participle clauses – absolute constructions

Part A · Multiple Choice

1	**c)** The weather being	An absolute clause has its own subject + participle.
2	**a)** finished	Subject + past participle = the work was finished.
3	**d)** having	Subject + having + past participle shows an earlier action.
4	**b)** closed	Eyes are closed: past participle.
5	**b)** With	With + noun + participle.
6	**d)** The rain having stopped, we went out.	The participle clause has its own subject.
7	**a)** All things	All things considered is a fixed phrase.
8	**c)** being over	Subject + being + complement.
9	**d)** soaked	Her hair was soaked: past participle.
10	**a)** being	Subject + being + adjective.

Part B · Fill in the Gaps

11	**being**	Subject + being + adjective.
12	**finished** (or: done)	Subject + past participle.
13	**set**	Having + past participle.
14	**folded** (or: crossed)	Arms are folded.
15	**All**	All things considered is fixed.
16	**being**	Subject + being + adjective.
17	**finished** (or: done)	Subject + past participle.
18	**open**	With + noun + adjective.
19	**having**	Subject + having + past participle.
20	**late** (or: delayed, cancelled, full)	Subject + being + adjective.

Part C · Unscramble the Words

21	**The weather being nice, we went out.**	Own subject + being.
22	**The work finished, she went home.**	Own subject + past participle.
23	**The sun having set, we returned.**	Own subject + having + participle.
24	**He sat there, his eyes closed.**	Noun + past participle.
25	**All things considered, it went well.**	Fixed phrase.

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26	**Her mother being ill, she stayed home.**	Own subject + being.
27	**With the door open, we heard everything.**	With + noun + adjective.
28	**The guests having left, we cleaned up.**	Own subject + having + participle.

Part D · Choose and Complete

29	**The weather being**	Own subject + being.
30	**The work**	The clause needs its own subject.
31	**having**	Subject + having + participle.
32	**closed**	Eyes are closed.
33	**All**	All things considered.
34	**being**	Own subject + being.
35	**having**	Subject + having + participle.

Part E · Matching

36	**1-C 2-A 3-D 4-B**	The weather being nice, – Because the weather was nice,; The work finished, – After the work was finished,; Her mother being ill, – Since her mother was ill,; All things considered, – Taking everything into account, Absolute clauses give reason or time.
37	**1-B 2-C 3-D 4-A**	The sun having set, – we went back.; Dinner over, – they moved to the lounge.; The exams finished, – the students celebrated.; With the door open, – we heard everything. Choose the natural ending.
38	**1-D 2-C 3-B 4-A**	The rain having stopped – perfect participle; The work finished – past participle; The weather being nice – present participle; With the lights off – with + noun + adjective Absolute clauses have several forms.
39	**1-D 2-A 3-B 4-C**	As the train was late, – The train being late,; When the work had been done, – The work done,; After the sun had set, – The sun having set,; Since the shop was closed, – The shop being closed, Reduce the clause but keep its subject.
40	**1-B 2-D 3-A 4-C**	Own subject – Appears before the participle; Formal style – Common in writing and speeches; Meaning – Gives reason, time or condition; Fixed phrase – All things considered Features of absolute clauses.

Part F · Find the Error

41	**being**	Use being, not been.
42	**finished**	Use the past participle.
43	**having set**	Use having + past participle.
44	**folded**	Use the past participle.
45	**things**	The fixed phrase is all things considered.
46	**cancelled**	Use the past participle.
47	**she stayed**	Remove so; no linker is needed.
48	**stopped**	Having + past participle.

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49	**off** (or: turned off)	With + noun + adjective.
50	**being over**	Use being + complement.

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